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semiconductor AI startup
SixSense raises \$8.5M

Kate Park — 5:00 PM PDT · July 31, 2025

A Singapore-based deep tech startup called [SixSense](#) has developed an AI-powered platform that helps semiconductor manufacturers predict and detect potential chip defects on production lines in real time.

It has raised \$8.5 million in Series A bringing its total funding to around \$12 million. The round was led by Peak XV's Surge (formerly Sequoia India & SEA), with participation from Alpha Intelligence Capital, FEBE, and others.

Founded in 2018 by engineers Akanksha Jagwani (CEO) and Avni Agrawal (CTO), SixSense aims to address a fundamental challenge in semiconductor manufacturing: converting raw production data, from defect images to equipment signals, into real-time insights that help factories prevent quality issues and improve yield.

Despite the sheer scale of the problem, it took out to the co-founders.

Akanksha brings a background in control, and software automation solutions. She led product development with technical experience in data analytics systems. A skilled engineer, she had long been interested in fintech.

Together, the duo landed on semiconductor. With a reputation for precision and fragmented, Akanksha has more than 50 engineers working to modernize how quality is managed.

Fabs today are filled with complex systems, but most are slow, she said. "The burden of quality is on the fab."

[they must] spot patterns, investigate anomalies, and trace root causes. That's time-consuming, subjective, and doesn't scale well with increasing process complexity."

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IMAGE CREDITS: SIXSENSE

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SixSense provides engineers with early warnings to address potential issues before they escalate with capabilities such as defect detection, root cause analysis, and failure prediction.

SixSense's platform is also specifically designed to be used by process engineers rather than data scientists, Agarwal said. "Process engineers can fine-tune models using their own fab data, deploy them in under two days, and trust the results — all without writing a single line of code. That's what makes the platform both powerful and practical."

The competitive landscape includes in-house engineering teams using tools like Cognex and Halcon, inspection equipment makers integrating AI into their systems, and startups including Landing.ai and Robovision.

SixSense's AI platform is already in use at major semiconductor

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ent
Jules is now out of beta

Jagmeet Singh — 9:00 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: JAGMEET SINGH / TECHCRUNCH

Google on Wednesday launched its AI coding agent, Jules, out of beta, just over two months after its [public preview debut in May](#).

Powered by Gemini 2.5 Pro, Jules is an asynchronous, agent-based coding tool that integrates with GitHub, clones codebases into Google Cloud virtual machines, and uses AI to fix or update code while developers focus on other tasks.

Google [initially announced](#) Jules as a Google Labs project in December and made it [available to beta testers](#) through a public preview at its I/O developer conference.

Kathy Korevec, director of product at Google Labs, told TechCrunch that the tool's improved stability drove the decision to take it out of beta after receiving hundreds of UI and quality updates during its beta phase.

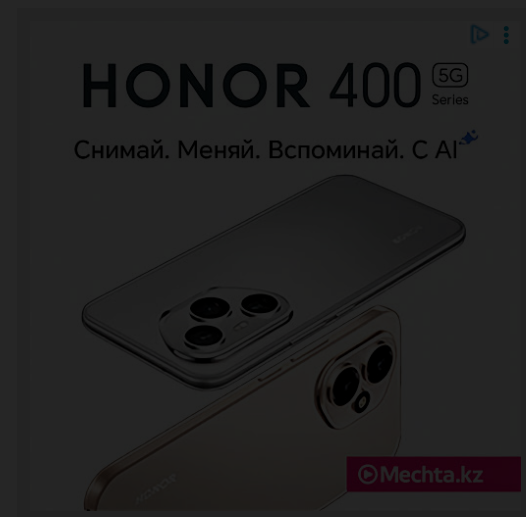
"The trajectory of Jules is around an

With the wider rollout of Jules, starting with individual daily tasks, we'll limit during beta. Our plans, which are presented to subscribers 5x and

Korevec noted that "usage" insights gathered

"The 60-task cap on the information we deliver 15/day is designed to help them on real projects

Google also updated it trains AI. If a report is private, Korevec



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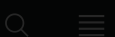
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IMAGE CREDITS: JULES / X

The two primary use cases for Jules are professional developers and non-professional developers.

By running asynchronous tasks, Jules can top AI coding tools and run tasks synchronously and asynchronously.

“Jules operates like a personal assistant, taking tasks to it, and then it can do it if you want and then it can do tasks done for you. It can be used using a synchronous or asynchronous approach,” Korevec explained.

This week, Jules released a new feature called [requests automation](#) and a new feature called [Env](#) scripts as a snapshot of the current state of the application.

From vibe coding to production-ready code, Jules provides the information you need to get your project up and running.

Since entering public beta, Jules has logged 2.28 million visits worldwide, 45% of them from mobile devices, per data from market intelligence provider [SimilarWeb](#), reviewed by TechCrunch. India was the top market for traffic, followed by the U.S. and Vietnam.

Google did not share specifics on Jules’ user base and its top geographies.

Korevec told TechCrunch that during the beta, the team observed that many people used Jules from traditional vibe-coding tools to either fix bugs that might have been implemented or extend the vibe-coded project to make it more production-ready.



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Originally, Jules required users to have an existing codebase. But Google soon realized many potential users — like those trying other AI tools — might want to explore it without one. Korevec said the company quickly enabled Jules to work even with an empty repository. That helped increase its scope and usage.

Google Labs’ team also noticed an increasing number of users accessing Jules through their mobile devices. Although the tool does not have a dedicated mobile app, Korevec said users were accessing it through its web app.

“Since it’s a big use case that we’re seeing emerging, we’re absolutely exploring what the features are that people need on mobile a lot more,” she noted.

Alongside beta testers, Google helped develop some of the tool’s features. “We use the tool on “a

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Jagmeet Singh

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Jagmeet covers startups, tech policy-related updates, and all other major tech-centric developments from India for TechCrunch. He previously worked as a...

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It's not clear whet
such a discounted rate, though GSA Federal Acquisition Service
commissioner Josh Gruenbaum in a [statement](#) encouraged "other
American AI technology companies to follow OpenAI's lead and work
with us."

TechCrunch has reached out to Anthropic and Google for more
information.

In addition to access to ChatGPT Enterprise, OpenAI is offering unlimited
use of advanced models for an additional 60 days. Federal employees
will also have access to a new government user community and tailored
introductory training resources to get familiar with OpenAI's tools.

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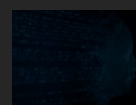
TRANSPORTATION



Tesla shuts down Dojo, the AI training supercomputer that Musk said would be key to full self-driving

Rebecca Bellan - 4 hours ago

STARTUPS



High costs and thin margins threatening AI coding startups

Marina Temkin - 5 hours ago

AI



OpenAI's GPT-5 is here

Maxwell Zeff - 9 hours ago

Data security is a top priority for government agencies that are concerned about sensitive information being leaked into model training sets. TechCrunch has asked the GSA for details on how government data is being safeguarded, including whether measures like on-premises or private cloud deployments are being used to enhance security.

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"The government GSA spokesperson remains protected efficiencies."

OpenAI's discount administration put center buildouts and other things. It also and AI models that contracts.

TechCrunch has no partnership and h

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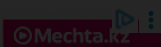


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Rebecca Bellan

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Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch where she covers the business, policy, and emerging trends shaping artificial intelligence. Her work has also...

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